CLAUDE CODE FOR KNOWLEDGE WORK · #1

Start here: set up your first Claude Code folder

FOR YOU

Put this file in an empty folder. Open that folder in the Code tab (the </> icon at the top) of the Claude desktop app, and type:

Read START-HERE.pdf and set me up.

FOR CLAUDE

You're helping someone set up their first Claude Code folder. Do these three things, in order.

1. Before any question, tell them in three short lines what this folder is: it holds their assistant for one role; what you should remember lives here, starting with a CLAUDE.md of their guidelines and later skills for repeat jobs; it's theirs to change, back up and grow.

2. Then the person who opened this folder asks you to do the following, in their own words:

   > Interview me one short question at a time about my role, the people I work with, and how I like my work written. When you have enough, show me a draft CLAUDE.md for this folder, and ask whether any part should go in my global CLAUDE.md instead, so it applies to all my work. Don't write any files until I say 'OK, write it'. Keep them short.

3 When you draft and write the CLAUDE.md files, follow these best practices:

1. Write only what you can't learn by yourself: their role, the people they work with, where their files are, and how they like their work done. Include how they want your replies (how long, what comes first, words they never want to see) and whether you should do only what they asked or may go further.
2. Make each line specific, and give each preference a short reason in their own words (for example: "bullets for my boss, she reads on her phone").
3. Keep it short: plain headings and bullets, short enough to read in a minute (Anthropic's ceiling is 200 lines).
4. The global file is how they work everywhere; this folder's file is this role, its people and its files. Say nothing twice, and never let the two disagree. The global file lives at ~/.claude/CLAUDE.md (the .claude folder in their home folder); open it with exactly that path, ~ included: your file tools understand ~, so you never need their username. If it exists, read it first, then add to it or update lines in it; never delete what they didn't ask to change. If it doesn't exist, create it.
5. Leave out passwords, keys and anything they wouldn't want written in a file.
6. Read the draft back in plain words and ask what is missing or too much. Once it is saved, suggest one quick test: start a new conversation, ask for an everyday task, and check the reply against the file. Then tell them one next step: when they like a result, they can say "Review this conversation and turn it into a skill." Add this line to their folder's CLAUDE.md: "When I correct you on the same thing twice, offer to add a line to this file."

TIPS FOR YOU

- Turn on plan mode first and Claude shows you its plan before writing anything.
- Answer out loud if you can (voice dictation is faster and you'll say more).
- You don't need perfect answers. You can always ask Claude to update the file later.

From the video Claude Code for Beginners (Ep. 1) by Terence Bristol · free, no sign-up: github.com/TerenceBristol/terencebristol-toolkit